



STATUS REPORT

South Africa: status report

Edition of 2026-08-10 • 92 systems and instruments tracked, 11 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-10 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/ZAF/ledger.csv](#) (92 systems and instruments, 11 of them Not held). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

South Africa has a data-protection statute in force, a gazetted national frequency plan, a central bank holding a 50% stake in the instant payment rail, a reform programme publishing quarterly targets, and the African cloud regions of Google, Microsoft and Amazon. Most national-scale citizen-facing systems remain at pilot or pre-launch stage. Operation Vulindlela's first-quarter report for 2026/27 states that reform progress "has been uneven and, in certain instances, slower than initially anticipated due to the complexity of institutional reforms" ([National Treasury and the Presidency, 2026-07-31](#)). A Public Service Commission investigation reported in July 2026 that the State Information Technology Agency carries [more than R2bn in irregular expenditure](#); separate reporting put procurement attrition at 25.2% and recorded [contracts outstanding beyond 400 days](#).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Draft Radio Frequency Spectrum and Fees Regulations amendments	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Public hearings 2026-08-19/20
Equinix Cape Town land use	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Tribunal approval 2026-07-14
High-demand spectrum auction	PLANNED	No date; R51m appropriated
IMT Roadmap 2026 and draft assignment plans	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Consultation opened 2026-07-24
Innovation spectrum, lower 6GHz	IMPLEMENTED	Gazetted 2026-05-22
LEO satellite licensing framework	PLANNED ↗	Policy direction rejected 2026-05

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National broadband map (DBSA)	IMPLEMENTED, NOT PUBLIC ↗	2026-03
National CSIRT (Cybersecurity Hub)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Since 2015
National Cybersecurity Policy Framework	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Approved by Cabinet 2012-03
National GIS infrastructure database (rapid deployment reg. 7)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Draft gazetted 2026-04
National Radio Frequency Plan 2026	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Gazetted 2026-07-24
SA Connect phase 2	DISCONTINUED ↗	Closed 2026-02
Satellite market entry via section 13	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Amazon Leo–Herotel, 2026-07-15
State Digital Infrastructure Company (network merger)	PLANNED ↗	Deferred to 2028/29
Data-centre incentive instrument (SEZ, depreciation, grid priority)	NOT HELD	Signalled 2026-02

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Teraco CT2, Cape Town	IMPLEMENTED ↗	+32MW to 50MW, 2025-11

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Integrated Cyber Infrastructure System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	At maximum capacity, 2026-08-05

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Electronic Communications Amendment Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Submissions close 2026-08-21

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Draft National Policy on Data and Cloud	PLANNED ↗	Draft of 2021, unresolved

Mapping for the Development Bank of Southern Africa puts fourth-generation coverage at 98% of the population, 12.2% of households more than 20km from a fibre node and over 6,700 of roughly 15,000 public schools between 10km and 25km from one; the [data is bank-owned and not published](#). SA Connect phase two [closed](#) having connected 6,343 government facilities and 32,055 community hotspots against a 2022 target of universal access, and [Broadband Infraco is reported as technically insolvent](#). The regulator [rejected the minister's equity-equivalence policy direction](#) in May 2026, holding that a policy direction cannot override the Electronic Communications Act. [Draft amendments to the spectrum and fee regulations](#), on which oral hearings are set for 19-20 August 2026, would put satellite space-segment operators on a register.

The data-centre estate runs to over 50 facilities at roughly 350MW of combined critical load, [according to Teraco](#). Cape Town's planning tribunal [approved two Equinix facilities](#) on an application that did not disclose water or electricity demand. The Centre for High Performance Computing, one of three pillars of the National Integrated Cyber Infrastructure System, [has reached maximum capacity](#), Parliament's science committee reported after an oversight visit on 2026-08-05.

The national CSIRT is the Cybersecurity Hub, set up in 2015 under the National Cybersecurity Policy Framework Cabinet approved in March 2012; it [routes a reported incident to a sector CSIRT or to the police rather than resolving it, operates 08:00-16:30 on weekdays and publishes no incident statistics or annual report](#). The only national cyber-security measurement held dates from 2024: [88% of organisations reported a breach in the preceding twelve months](#) (n=309), and [62% of cyber-security posts partially or fully unfilled](#).

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
MzansiXchange data exchange	PILOTING ↗	Nine months in, 2026-07
SAHPRA VigiFlow serious-adverse-event e-reporting pilot	PILOTING ↗	Communication to industry CT02-2026/27, 2026-08-03
SARS-Malawi customs data exchange	PLANNED ↗	Arrangement signed 2026-08-05

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital driving licence	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Nearest dated milestone 2027-03
Draft Identification Regulations amendments	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Consultation closed 2026-06
Electronic travel authorisation	PILOTING ↗	National launch 2026-08-12
National digital identity (credential and wallet)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Hosting due 2027-03-31

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Capitec-Walletdoc merger conditions	PLANNED, BEFORE THE COMPETITION TRIBUNAL ↗	Commission recommended approval 2026-08-06
CIPS participation (Standard Bank)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Went live and inaugurated at the SARB 2025-11-20
Payments Ecosystem Modernisation credential and wallet	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Testing due 2026-11
Renminbi Clearing Bank of Africa	IMPLEMENTED ↗	PBoC authorisation announced 2026-06-26
Retail central bank digital currency	PLANNED, NOT PROCEEDING ↗	"No compelling case", 2026-06
ZARU rand-backed stablecoin	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Listed on Luno Global 2026-08-07

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Intelligent Population Register	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Announced 2026-06
National Population Register	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Operating; no current statement held

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Digital Health Strategy 2019-2024	DISCONTINUED, TERM EXPIRED 2024 ↗	Term expired 2024; no successor held
NSFAS student funding system	IMPLEMENTED, UNDER ADMINISTRATION ↗	Stabilisation plan submitted 2026-08-07

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Batho Pele AI chatbot	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-07-31
Digital matric certificate	PILOTING ↗	Integration due 2026-09
District Health Information System	IMPLEMENTED	Hosting out to tender 2026-07
Gauteng online school admissions	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2027 intake opened 2026-08-05
IEC digital voter registration (WhatsApp and online portal)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	WhatsApp channel launched 2026-08-04
Minimum Interoperability Standards and GWEA	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Update due 2026-09
MyMzansi single citizen application	PILOTING ↗	Stable platform due 2026-09
National Health Insurance information architecture	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Gazetted as the 2021 HNSF, GN 2667, 2022-10-21
National payment code standard (QR+)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	v1.2, eight-bank cohort, 2026-07
Non-bank payment service provider licensing	PLANNED	NPS Act amendment pending
Online Verification Service	IMPLEMENTED	Fee under review litigation
PayShap	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Standard gazetted 2026-07
SAMOS real-time gross settlement	IMPLEMENTED	Since 1998
Smart ID and bank-branch channel	IMPLEMENTED ↗	372 branches, 2026-08-05
Western Cape Infrastructure Virtual Platform (EVE AI agent)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched at inaugural Infrastructure Ministerial Roundtable, 2026-07-30
Education management information systems	NOT HELD	—
Electronic death registration system	NOT HELD	—

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Identification and Registration Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Before Parliament

The Department of Home Affairs' annual performance plan sets the only funded 2026/27 digital identity target as hosting infrastructure, with verifiable credentials [scheduled for 2027/28](#); the department issued [4,002,964 smart identity documents in 2025](#). The enabling regulations are being made under the Identification Act 1998 while the National Identification and Registration Bill remains before Parliament; an analyst [argued in May 2026 that they may be ultra vires](#) on that ground.

The smart identity document bank-branch channel reached [372 participating branches on 2026-08-05](#), from 327 on 2026-07-22, against a departmental target of 750 by end-2026; Home Affairs reported over half a million switches from the green barcoded identity book in under five months, against about 16 million people it says still hold one. It also reported [377,060 identity numbers blocked](#) as at July 2026, down from 702,267, and stated it cannot trace approximately 400,000 of those affected against a court deadline extended to March 2027. On 2026-07-29 the Western Cape High Court [held four categories of exclusion in the birth-registration regulations unconstitutional](#).

The information architecture for National Health Insurance sits inside the [2021 Health Normative Standards Framework](#): a federated model with central patient, provider and facility registries and a national health information exchange. The [National Digital Health Strategy 2019-2024](#), which proposed a national digital-health grant targeting three to five per cent of health expenditure, expired at the end of its term with no successor held.

PayShap had recorded 905m transactions by 2026-05, and the Reserve Bank holds [50% of the operating company](#), which it said on 2026-07-31 [will remain bank-owned](#). The Auditor-General identified [41 information-technology projects worth R12.1bn](#) that did not meet time, cost, quality or business objectives, naming health-system non-interoperability as a barrier to a unified patient platform.

No go-live date, purpose-limitation, retention or reciprocity term is published for the [customs data exchange signed with the Malawi Revenue Authority on 2026-08-05](#). The student funding scheme is under administration, its administrator reporting in August 2026 that [ICT is its biggest operational risk](#), "fragmented, manual and not fit for purpose".

Governance and regulation

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital Transformation of Government Roadmap	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Adopted 2025-03-26

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Capital Flow Management Regulations and Crypto Asset Manual	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Manual comments close end-September 2026
Copyright Amendment Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Returned to Parliament 2026-06
Cybercrimes Act	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In force since 2021

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
End-user and Subscriber Service Charter Amendment Regulations	ENACTED, IN FORCE 2027-01-23 ↗	Under review litigation
National Open Science Policy	IMPLEMENTED	No commencement date stated
SADC real-time settlement	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Kwanza added 2026-07-27
AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol domestication	NOT HELD	—
Cross-border transfer adequacy determinations	NOT HELD	—
Malabo Convention ratification position	NOT HELD	—

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cost to Communicate Roadmap	PLANNED ↗	Market analysis study put out to tender, reported 2026-08-01
Operation Vulindlela Phase II	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Quarterly reporting

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
ICT and Media Regulators Forum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2024

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Consumer Protection Act direct-marketing opt-out registry	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Regulations 2026-04
Mandatory breach reporting e-portal	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2025-04
Protection of Personal Information Act and Information Regulator	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Enforceable since 2021

The Information Regulator received 2,374 breach notifications in 2024/25 and [788 in the first quarter of 2026](#), and issued enforcement notices in 2026 against a public college and a mining company. The statutory maximum penalty is R10m, against an IBM-measured average South African breach cost of [R44.1m](#).

A peer-reviewed study found streaming services delivered over the open internet [fall outside licensing, local-content quotas and the Broadcasting Act](#). The bundle roll-over rules exclude bundles of seven days or less, which the regulator's reasons document states are mostly bought by low-income users; the two largest operators have [applied to have them set aside](#). The SADC real-time settlement system [added its second currency](#) in July 2026.

National Treasury published a draft [Crypto Asset Manual governing cross-border crypto transactions on 2026-08-03](#), for comment to end-September 2026. It states that the manual precedes its consideration of comments on the Capital Flow Management Regulations it implements, proposed in April 2026 with penalties of up to R1 million, five years' imprisonment or both.

On price, the department put a market analysis study [out to tender](#), reported 2026-08-01, its terms conceding a "current policy vacuum" and that the price benefits expected from the 2022 spectrum auction "remain largely unmet". Its deliverable, a Cost to Communicate Roadmap, is not published.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Conduct of Financial Institutions Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Before Parliament

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National AI policy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Cabinet targeted 2026-11

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
AI-in-finance regulatory framework	PLANNED ↗	Expected 2026
Crypto-asset service provider licensing	IMPLEMENTED ↗	310 licences by 2026-03-31

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Expert review panel	IMPLEMENTED	14 members appointed 2026-05-14
Proposed AI regulatory institutions	PLANNED, UNDER RECONSIDERATION ↗	2026-07
Prudential Authority AI and cloud supervision standards	IN DEVELOPMENT	2026-07
SAHPRA AI/ML medical-device requirements	IMPLEMENTED, REGISTRATION NOT COMMENCED ↗	Issued 2025-09-26
SARS Modernisation 3.0	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Programme announced 2026-04
Sector-level AI strategies	PLANNED	Per redraft approach
AI incident or assurance register	NOT HELD	—
Rules governing state automated decision-making	NOT HELD	—

The draft AI policy was withdrawn in April 2026 after fabricated references were identified, and the department stated on 2026-07-29 that the replacement [will issue guidelines rather than prescribe rules](#), with cabinet targeted for November 2026 and January 2027 as fallback. Two timelines are on record and have not been reconciled. The medicines regulator [set binding requirements for AI and machine-learning medical devices in September 2025](#), requiring authorisation before use, prior approval from one of six reference jurisdictions or WHO prequalification

for Class C and D devices, and evidence that a foreign-trained model performs on local populations — while stating in the same document that it has not commenced product registration of medical devices at all and that AI-specific pathways are still to be developed.

Automated decision-making is nonetheless in operation. The minister reported that the electronic travel authorisation had [processed 203,000 applications and rejected more than 5,700](#) by 2026-07-21, with approximately [85% assessed automatically](#); the department publishes no statistical series, and no appeal route, accuracy rate or human-review threshold. The Labour Court [stayed disciplinary proceedings](#) in July 2026 on prima facie evidence that a ruling relied on non-existent authorities. In [PwC research](#) among mining executives (n=10, interviews and focus groups), nearly 70% rated AI readiness poor or very poor and more than 85% rated data management average or poor. Start-up funding recorded \$335.9m across 42 ventures in 2025 on a measure its publisher describes as a minimum floor, and South Africa [ranked fourth on the continent at \\$83m](#) in the first half of 2026.

Inclusion and capacity

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Bank-account means test across eight grants	IMPLEMENTED, UNDER APPEAL ↗	SCA hearing 2026-08-25
MICT SETA	IMPLEMENTED, UNDER GOVERNANCE REVIEW ↗	Referred 2026-07
Postbank Black Card migration	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Deadline 2026-08-31
SASSA biometric verification against Home Affairs	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Compulsory for new applications, 2025-09
Smartphone excise removal	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2025-04
Digital inclusion strategy instrument	NOT HELD	—
Municipal ICT expenditure data	NOT HELD	—
National digital literacy measurement	NOT HELD	—

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Competency Framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	2026-07
National Digital and Future Skills Strategy 2020	UNDER REVIEW ↗	2026-07

The bank-account means test has been [extended from one grant to eight](#) while the 2025 judgment declaring it unconstitutional is suspended pending appeal, and beneficiaries flagged from September 2025 have [reported continued non-payment](#). Removal of the 9% excise on smartphones under R2,500 was followed by an 80% rise in entry-level volumes and an 87% fall in feature-phone sales [to February 2026](#), figures published by the minister.

Of 463,836 active Postbank gold cards at 2026-04-29, [264,263 were still to be replaced at 2026-07-28](#), against a deadline of 2026-08-31. Across 56 national budget lines drawn from the [Estimates of National Expenditure](#), execution against appropriation for 2024/25 to 2026/27 runs at 86% and 87% for the international and information-society programmes, and at 39% for SA Connect. Home Affairs has tabled [R13.8bn for 2026/27](#).

Finance

The base holds no finance rows for South Africa. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.

(narrative not yet written)

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Data-centre incentive instrument (SEZ, depreciation, grid priority)	—	not yet probed
Education management information systems	—	not yet probed
Electronic death registration system	—	not yet probed
Cross-border transfer adequacy determinations	—	not yet probed
Malabo Convention ratification position	—	not yet probed
AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol domestication	—	not yet probed
Rules governing state automated decision-making	—	not yet probed
AI incident or assurance register	—	not yet probed
Digital inclusion strategy instrument	—	not yet probed
National digital literacy measurement	—	not yet probed
Municipal ICT expenditure data	—	not yet probed

The items above marked *Not held* fall into three groups. Firstly, sectoral systems: education management information systems and the electronic death registration system, together with the data-centre incentive instrument signalled in February 2026. Secondly, international instruments: cross-border transfer adequacy determinations under POPIA, the Malabo Convention ratification position and domestication of the AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol. Thirdly, measurement and the rules governing state automation: a national digital literacy baseline, a digital inclusion strategy instrument, municipal ICT expenditure data, an AI incident or assurance register, and any rule constraining state automated decision-making. United States and Chinese activity is documented, including Huawei's report of [1,400 local partners and 94.7% of local revenue](#); no European, Gulf or Indian digital instrument for South Africa is held.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-10
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.com/reports/ZAF/
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